

United Overseas Bank (UOBH.SI): First Take: Beat on lower credit cost offsetting lower PPOP on weaker non-NII

UOB posted **4Q25 net profit of S\$1,410mn, -7% yoy/+218% qoq, +5% vs. GSe.**

Driving the beat was the **lower credit cost of 19bps vs GSe's 30bps** with SPs at 26bps with reversal of GPs of -7bps. NPAs fell 6% qoq with new NPAs lower qoq though still elevated at S\$599m (vs S\$838m in 3Q25 and S\$472mn in 2Q25) offset by large upgrades, recoveries and write-offs at S\$957m this quarter. GP coverage on performing loans including RLAR stayed steady at 1.0%. **PPOP was a miss with (1) Non NII was weaker than GSe as fee income came in slightly below GSe -2% but up 2% qoq and other non-NII that missed (-32% vs GSe) -39% qoq, (2) NII came in inline at +4%qoq with NIM higher at 1.84% and loan growth of 0.3%qoq. (3) Cost was well controlled with CIR at 46.5%.** UOB announced a final dividend of 71 cents bringing total underlying payout to 50%.

UOB largely maintains 2026 guidance, with the only change being (1) Fee growth of high single digit (GSe 10%) vs high single to double digit prior with all else unchanged with (2) Loan growth to be low single digit (GSe of 3%); (3) FY NIM guidance of 1.75% - 1.80% (GSe NIM 1.77%); (4) Credit cost to be between 25-30bps (GSe at 30bps); (5) Low single digit operating expenses (GSe of 3%).

Overall, a better showing on lower credit cost with GP coverage on performing loans remaining at 1%. We see recent outperformance of UOB likely already factoring this in. There are no further disclosures on CRE exposure which makes it difficult to anticipate lower provisions going forward. Furthermore, this quarter's net new money was weak at c.S\$2bn vs S\$3/5bn respectively in 2Q25/3Q25. We await for more clarity on their view on provisions coverage and CRE outlook going forward and better understanding of the weaker NNM and its trajectory going forward. UOB is holding a media briefing at 9.00am local time, followed by an analyst briefing at 10.15am.

Key highlights:

- **Net interest income was 1% higher than GSe**, +4% qoq/-4% yoy. Loan growth was flattish at +0.3% qoq / +4% yoy. The qoq growth was flattish as growth in Singapore and ASEAN was offset by rest of the world and greater China.
- **NIM increased 2bps qoq to 1.84%**, higher than GSe of 1.82%, due to improved funding cost (+19bps qoq), partially offset by asset repricing (-15bps qoq) due to the decline in SORA. LDR lowered to 82.7% from 83.7% in 3Q25.
- **Non-interest income was 14% lower than GSe**, -17% qoq/ -7% yoy. Fees and

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commission gross income increased 2% qoq, supported by higher card fee while partly offset by seasonal weakness in loan-related and wealth fees. Other non-interest income declined 39% qoq driven by lower trading and investment income along with year-end tapering of customer treasury flow.

- **NPL ratio decreased to 1.50%**, as higher upgrades, recoveries and write-offs at S\$957m offset still elevated though lower qoq new NPL formation of S\$599m in 4Q25 (vs S\$838m in 3Q25 and S\$472mn in 2Q25).
- **Credit cost in total has normalised down to 13bp on our calculation** with CoC on loans at 19bps. NPA coverage slightly decreased to 97% from 100% at 3Q25 and unsecured NPA coverage was 254% from 240% at 3Q25. GP coverage on performing loans including RLAR stayed steady at 1.0%.
- **Expenses were -1% below GSe**, -2% yoy with cost to income ratio (CIR) for the quarter coming in at 46.5%.

We are Neutral rated on UOB. Our 12-month 2-stage DDM-based target price is S\$40.70. Downside risks: Unexpected acceleration or deeper Fed cut cycle. Changes in strategy to return capital. Unexpected deterioration in asset quality.

Exhibit 1: 4Q25 earnings summary

Income statement (\$mn)	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	4Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Net Interest Income	2,452	2,409	2,336	2,265	2,346	(4)	4	2,320	1
Fee & Commission	567	694	636	615	625	10	2	637	(2)
Other Non-Interest Income	442	554	493	518	318	(28)	(39)	466	(32)
Non-Interest Income	1,009	1,248	1,129	1,133	943	(7)	(17)	1,103	(14)
Operating Income	3,461	3,657	3,465	3,398	3,289	(5)	(3)	3,423	(4)
Operating Expenses	(1,559)	(1,559)	(1,536)	(1,535)	(1,528)	(2)	(0)	(1,542)	(1)
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	1,902	2,098	1,929	1,863	1,761	(7)	(5)	1,881	(6)
Loan Loss Provisions	(227)	(290)	(279)	(1,361)	(113)	(50)	(92)	(265)	(57)
Pre-tax Profit	1,685	1,822	1,638	520	1,677	(1)	223	1,632	3
Net Profit	1,522	1,490	1,338	443	1,410	(7)	218	1,343	5

Balance sheet (\$mn)	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	4Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Assets	537,664	538,009	537,838	555,419	572,061	6	3	562,213	2
Gross Loans	337,831	341,154	342,900	351,084	352,180	4.2	0.3	354,487	(1)
Non-Performing Loans	5,164	5,458	5,341	5,617	5,379	4	(4)	6,021	(11)
Customer Deposits	403,978	401,250	405,076	419,660	425,938	5	1	425,304	0

CAMEL Ratios (%)	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	4Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Core Tier 1	15.4	15.4	15.1	14.5	14.9			15.0	
NPL Ratio	1.53	1.60	1.56	1.60	1.50			1.70	
Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	27	34	33	157	13			30	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.00	2.00	1.91	1.82	1.84			1.82	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	45.0	42.6	44.3	45.2	46.5			45.1	
Loan-to-Deposits	83.6	85.0	84.7	83.7	82.7			83.3	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

UOBH.SI	12m Price Target: S\$40.70	Price: S\$38.80	Upside: 4.9%		
Neutral Market cap: S\$64.7bn / \$51.1bn 3m ADTV: S\$107.1mn / \$83.6mn Singapore Asia Financials M&A Rank: 3	GS Forecast				
		12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
	Net inc. (\$ mn)	6,044.0	4,620.6	5,646.8	5,986.9
	EPS (\$\$)	3.51	2.70	3.32	3.52
	EPS growth (%)	6.0	(23.2)	22.8	6.2
	P/E (X)	8.9	14.4	11.7	11.0
	P/B (X)	1.1	1.3	1.3	1.2
	ROA (%)	1.1	0.8	1.0	1.0
	ROE (%)	13.1	9.5	11.3	11.5
	Price/PPOP (X)	7.9	8.3	8.3	7.8
	Dividend yield (%)	7.3	3.9	4.5	4.7
		9/25	12/25E	3/26E	6/26E
	EPS (\$\$)	0.26	0.78	0.86	0.82

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 23 Feb 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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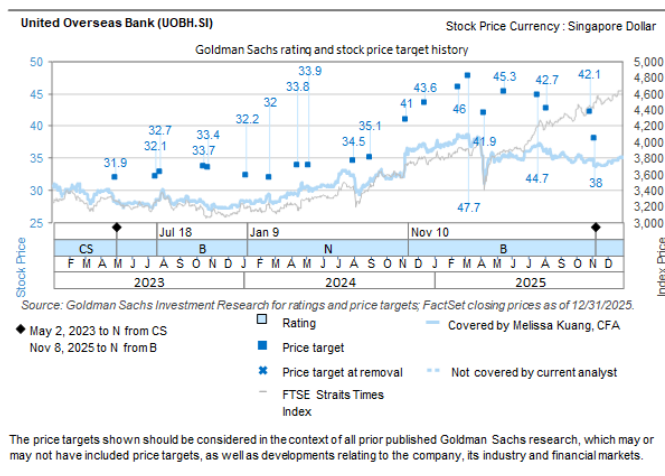
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